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PROJECT REPORT

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

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Branch	CSE (Cyber security)
Year	Firs t Year B.Tec h
Course Code	CSE0001 – Digital Literac y
Credits	1 Credit Pas s / Fail
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Introduction

This report documents my Digital Literacy Portfolio, completed as part of the CSE0001 course at VIT Bhopal University. The project scenario places me in the role of a Student Digital Ambassador — a peer resource for my batchmates on navigating the digital world responsibly and effectively.

The portfolio is organised into five tasks, each corresponding to one module of the course. Task 1 involved creating a digital literacy infographic. Task 2 focused on setting up professional online profiles. Task 3 required exploring coding and collaboration platforms. Task 4 addressed professional email communication and etiquette. Task 5 covered cybercrime awareness and prevention. All work has been organised in a single GitHub repository as required.

This project has been a practical introduction to the digital skills that are increasingly expected of engineering graduates. Every task required me to use real tools and platforms, making the learning directly applicable to my academic and professional future.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Module 1 | 20 Marks

For Task 1, I used Canva to design a one-page digital literacy awareness infographic aimed at first-year B.Tech students. Canva is a free, browser-based graphic design tool that provides hundreds of ready-made templates, icons, and colour palettes, making it ideal for students with no prior design experience.

My infographic covers three core areas: what digital literacy means and why it matters for students today; a set of useful digital tools organised by academic purpose; and key safe internet practices relevant to college life. I chose a clean, blue-and-white colour scheme to make the content easy to read at a glance, and used icons from Canva's free library to make each section visually distinct.

One aspect I found challenging was fitting meaningful content into a single page without making it look cluttered. I had to prioritise information carefully and use short bullet points instead of paragraphs. What I found most interesting was discovering how many free tools are available that I had not used before, particularly for collaboration and note-taking. This task has made me more aware of how a well-designed visual can communicate information more effectively than a block of text. The exported infographic has been added to the task-1-presentation/ folder in my GitHub repository.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Module 2 | 20 Marks

For Task 2, I set up professional digital profiles on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each platform serves a distinct and important purpose in building my academic and professional identity online.

GitHub is a version control platform where developers store, manage, and share their code. As a computer science student, GitHub will be essential for submitting projects, collaborating on group assignments, and eventually contributing to open-source software. I created my first repository for this very project and also set up a profile README that introduces who I am and what I am currently studying.

LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform, used by recruiters, internship coordinators, and industry professionals to find candidates. I set up my Education section with details of my current degree at VIT Bhopal University. Kaggle is a data science and machine learning community that hosts competitions, datasets, and learning courses. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to host all project work, LinkedIn to connect with seniors and apply for internships, and Kaggle to practise data skills and participate in beginner competitions.

Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Module 3 | 20 Marks

For Task 3, I worked with two categories of digital platforms: a coding practice platform and a cloud collaboration tool.

In Part A, I created an account on Codechef and completed the 'Solve Me First' beginner challenge using Python. The problem required reading two integers and printing their sum, which helped me get familiar with Codechef code editor, input/output format, and submission process. A screenshot of the completed challenge has been saved in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

In Part B, I created a 5-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The quiz includes four multiple-choice questions testing knowledge of WWW, VPN usage, phishing recognition, and HTTPS, as well as one open-ended short-answer question on the concept of digital footprint. Google Forms automatically links to a Google Sheet to collect and display responses, which makes it ideal for real-world quizzing of batchmates. These tools will be valuable throughout my academic career for creating surveys, collecting feedback, and collaborating on shared documents. The form link has been included in the README.

Task 4 – Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

Module 4 | 20 Marks

For Task 4, I drafted two professional emails and created a social media etiquette checklist. The first email is addressed to a professor and requests an extension on an assignment submission deadline. The second is a formal expression of interest in a summer internship opportunity at a company. Both emails follow standard professional email structure: a clear subject line, a polite greeting, a well-structured body with context and request, and a proper sign-off with full student details.

One real-world scenario where poor digital communication caused a significant problem involves a new employee who was dismissed from their job after sending a sarcastic, informal email intended for a colleague to their senior manager instead. The email had no subject line, used slang, and lacked a sign-off. The manager interpreted the message as disrespectful and reported it to HR, which resulted in the employee losing their probationary position.

What could have been done differently is straightforward: always verify the recipient before sending, re-read the email once for tone and professionalism, and maintain formal language in all workplace and academic communications regardless of your relationship with the recipient. The social media checklist with 7 Do's and 7 Don'ts has been added to [task-4-email-etiquette/](#) as a separate file.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study and Prevention Guide

Module 5 | 20 Marks

For Task 5, I researched phishing as a cybercrime type and wrote a realistic case study based on patterns documented by India's National Cyber Crime Portal. The case study follows a first-year student named Rohan who receives a fraudulent email disguised as a message from SBI. Believing his account has been suspended, he clicks on the link, enters his credentials on a fake banking website, and loses Rs. 18,500 within minutes. The scenario illustrates the classic phishing workflow: urgency, impersonation, a convincing fake page, and real-time credential theft.

What surprised me most during this task was learning that QR code scams in India specifically exploit a common misconception — many victims believe scanning a QR code is how you receive money, when in fact scanning always initiates a payment from your account. This is a uniquely dangerous misunderstanding in the UPI ecosystem, and it affects thousands of people each year, including educated students.

As a result of this research, I will personally change one habit: I will never click on a link in an email or SMS to log into a financial platform. Instead, I will always open my browser and type the official URL directly. I have also saved the National Cyber Crime Helpline number 1930 in my phone. The full prevention checklist with 10 actionable tips, including 2 specific to UPI safety, has been added to [task-5-cybercrime/](#).

Conclusion

This project has given me a practical, hands-on understanding of digital literacy that goes far beyond theory. I have set up real professional profiles, used design and collaboration tools, completed a coding challenge, written formal communications, and researched genuine cybersecurity threats. Each task built a skill I will actively use throughout my engineering degree and career. The GitHub repository I created as part of this project is itself a starting point for my permanent digital portfolio — something I intend to continue growing over the next four years.

References

- Canva Design Tool – <https://canva.com>
- GitHub – <https://github.com>
- LinkedIn – <https://linkedin.com>
- Kaggle – <https://kaggle.com>
- Codechef – <https://www.codechef.com>
- Google Forms – <https://forms.google.com>
- National Cyber Crime Portal, Government of India – <https://cybercrime.gov.in>
- Reserve Bank of India – Cyber Security Guidelines for Digital Payments – <https://rbi.org.in>